

Abstract Art Production Enhances the Efficiency of Cognitive Reappraisal

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1 INTRODUCTION

- Emotion regulation allows us to manage the impact of aversive content and adapt to our dynamic environment.
- Reappraisal alters emotional responding by downregulating negative affect¹.
- Art production enhances affect² through multiple cognitive states³ associated with emotion regulation⁴.
- Enhanced emotion regulation can manifest as greater affect change or less cognitive effort required to do so⁵.

RESEARCH QUESTION

Does practicing art improve the ability to regulate negative emotions?

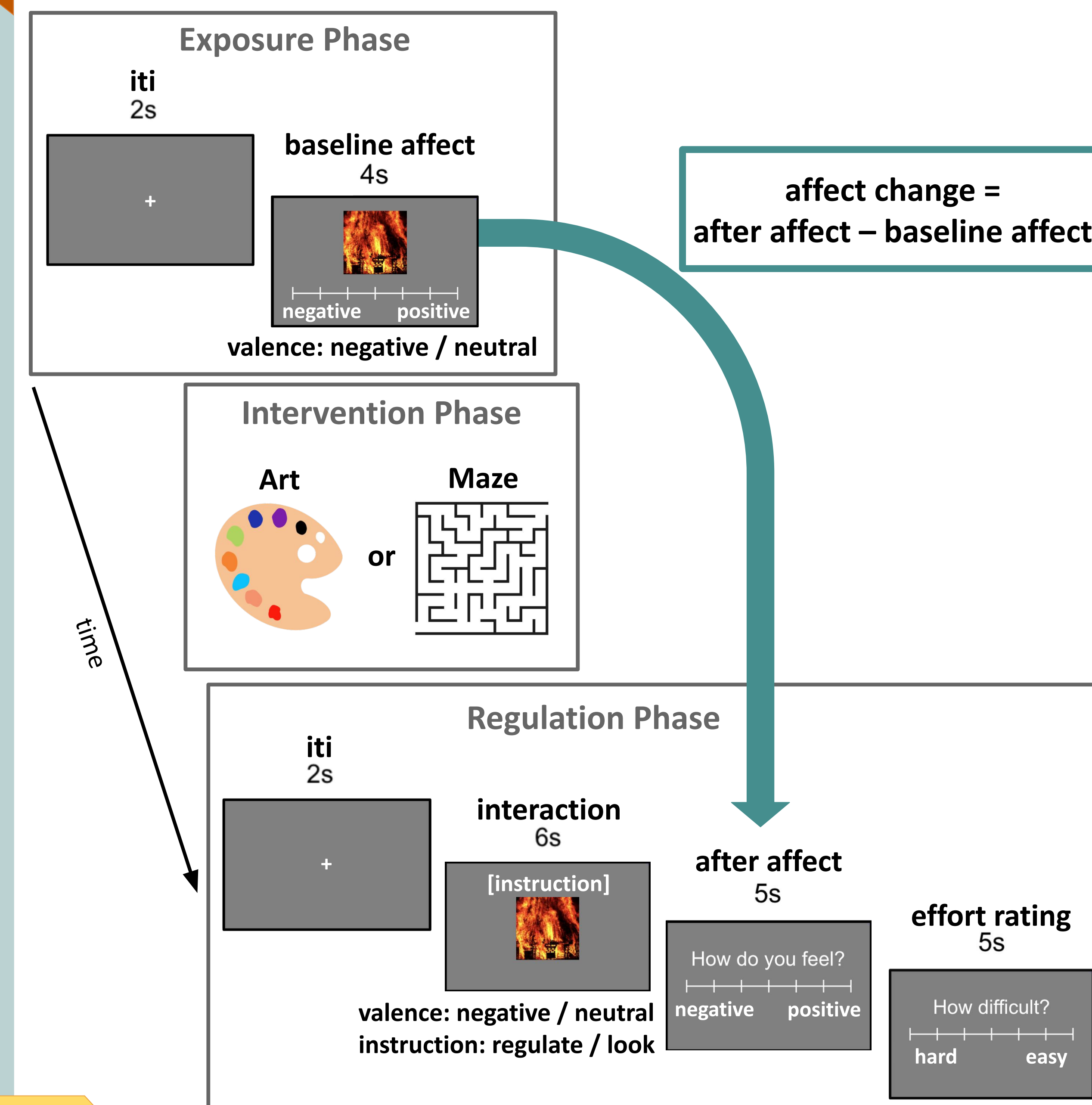
Reappraisal and art relationship

Reappraisal	Art
Attentional control ¹	→ Flow state ⁷
Emotional awareness ¹	→ Expression ⁸
Divergent thinking ⁶	→ Creativity ⁹

HYPOTHESES

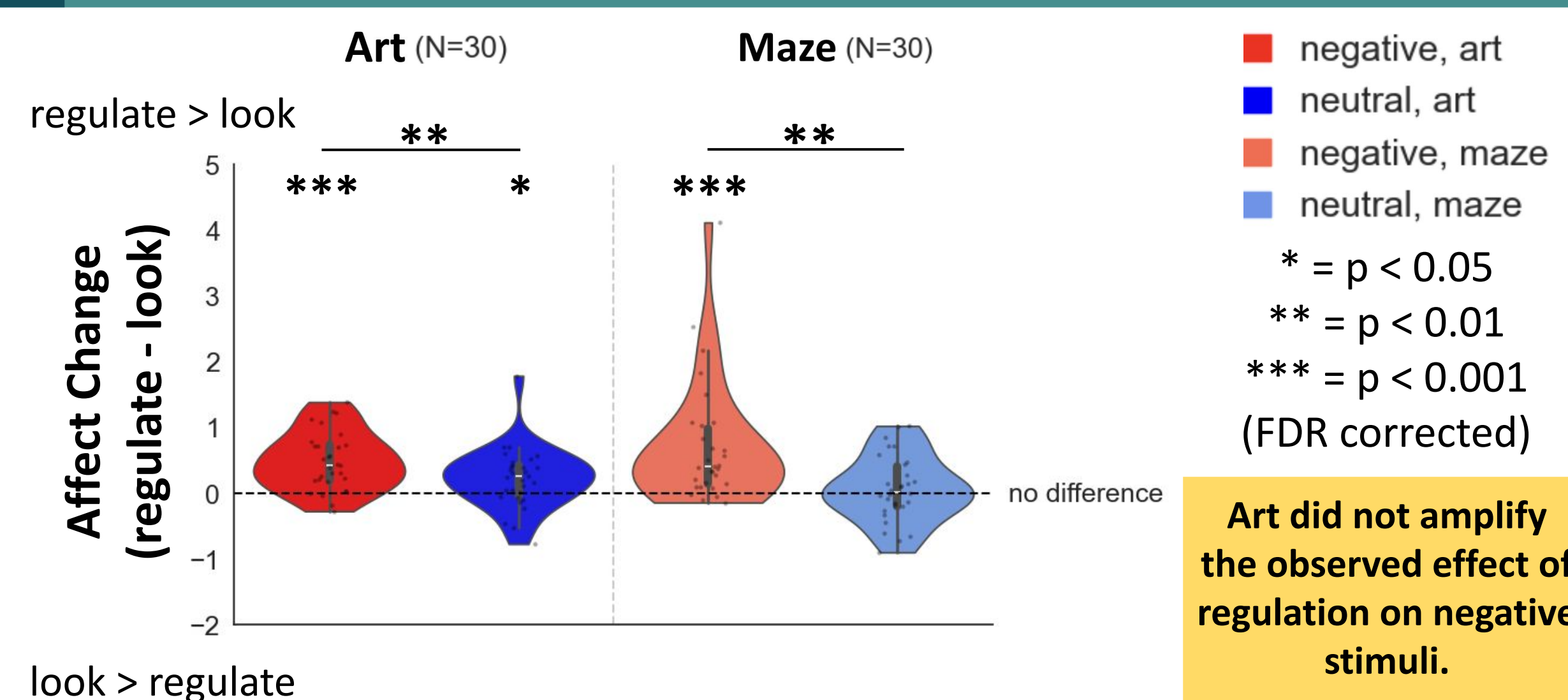
- Art will drive greater change in affect when reappraising negative content.
- Art will lead to more efficient reappraisal.

2 EXPERIMENTAL DESIGN



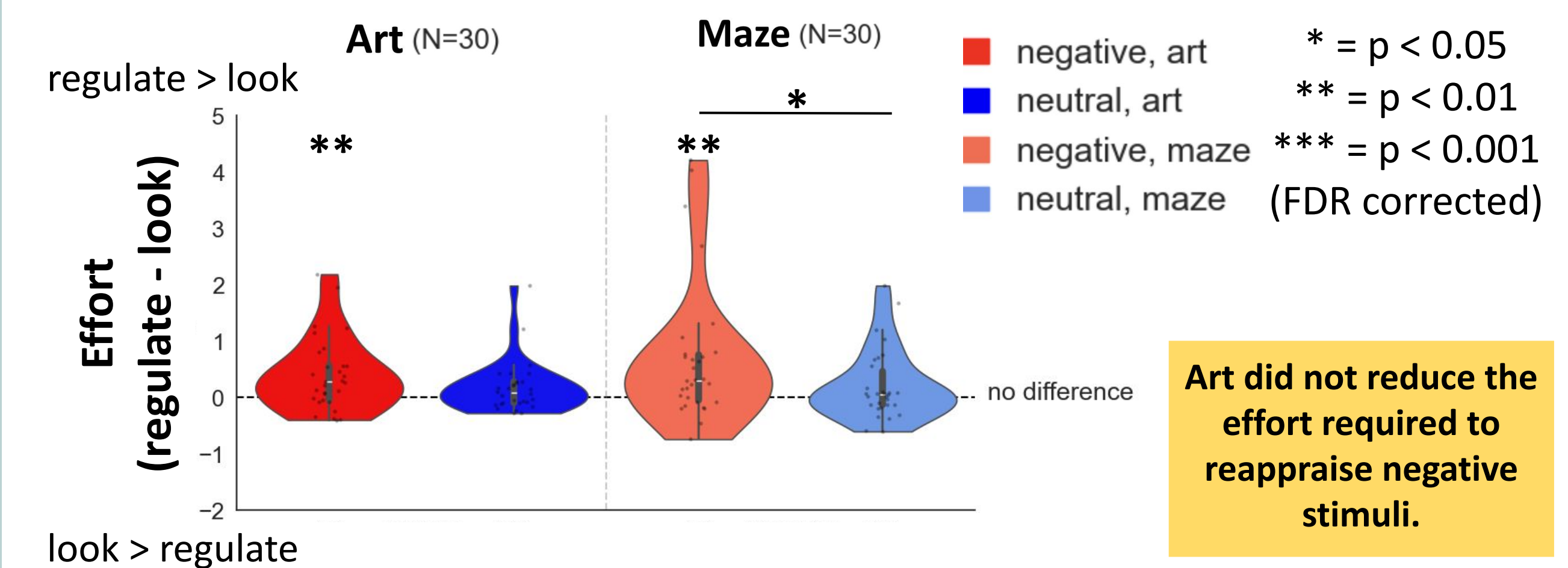
3 RESULTS

Reappraisal improves negative affect

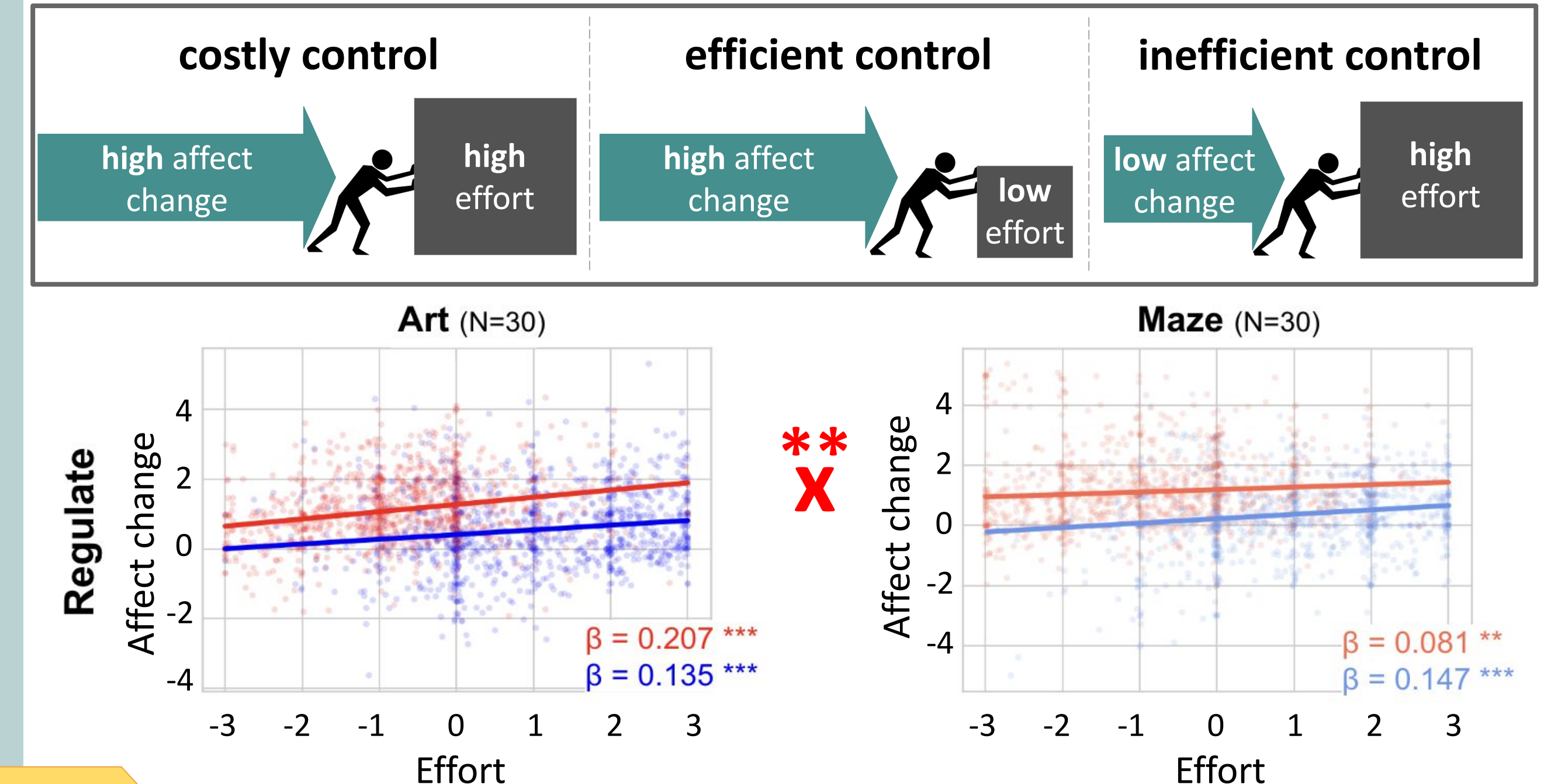


4 RESULTS

Regulating negative content requires more effort



Art amplifies affect change during effortful reappraisal



5 DISCUSSION

- A single session of art does not change overall regulation success, but makes effortful regulation more impactful.
- Abstract art practice may engage mechanisms that overlap with cognitive reappraisal, enhancing its efficiency.

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